



EVAN VUCCI Associated Press

PRESIDENT Trump shared his new stance at the World Economic Forum in Switzerland on Wednesday.

LAUSD LOOKING AT CUTS, LAYOFFS

District cites falling enrollment and fiscal doubt. Unions dispute the gloomy outlook.

By HOWARD BLUME

Los Angeles school officials warned this week of impending staff reductions — including likely layoffs — as they grapple with steadily falling enrollment and a three-year budget projection that ends with a deficit.

The budget uncertainty is exacerbated by ongoing Trump administration moves that threaten California school funding over culture war issues — including parental notification related to a student's gender identity and transgender athlete policies — under court review.

Also of concern is Gov. Gavin Newsom's proposal to withhold \$5.6 billion that would otherwise go toward K-12 public schools and community colleges. Newsom's move is a cautionary hedge against a future economic downturn. Education advocates have threatened legal action over the proposal.

The nation's second-largest school district is also facing pressure from rising costs and promised employee raises.

"It is not a foregone conclusion that people will lose jobs," Supt. Alberto Carvalho told the school board on Tuesday. In most cases, the job cuts "are about reducing or eliminating positions, not necessarily people. We're not sure if [layoffs] can be avoided in full, but I'm here to tell you that staff is working around the clock to minimize any and all impact."

He added: "Our highest priority will be to continue to protect classroom stability, core services and our workforce members to the greatest extent possible."

Los Angeles is not alone. The district is among about two-thirds of California public school systems working through cuts to programs and staff for next year, said Kevin Gordon, president of Capitol Advisors Group, an education lobbying firm that presented financial forecasts to the Board of Education on Tuesday.

"One of the things that we know that's going on is stress all across the board," Gordon said.

For the current year, the [See L.A. Unified, A11]

Suit alleges white pupils face bias

Plaintiffs target efforts to help L.A. schools with largely nonwhite student bodies. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Justices sound wary of president's Fed case

Trump's bid to fire Lisa Cook is met with concerns about preserving the central bank's independence

By David G. Savage

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court gave a skeptical hearing Wednesday to President Trump's claim that he has the power, acting alone, to fire Federal Reserve Board governor Lisa Cook for a past mistake on a mortgage application.

Most of the justices said they were not convinced that what Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. described as Cook's "inadvertent mistake" was grounds for removing her from the central bank board.

They also questioned Trump's failure to give her a hearing.

Justice Brett M. Kavanaugh told Trump's lawyer he had overplayed his hand.

"Your position is that there's no judicial review, no process required, no remedy available and a very low bar for cause that the president alone determines," he told Trump's Solicitor Gen. D. John Sauer. "That would weaken, if not shatter, the independence of the Federal Reserve."

"Why are you afraid of a hearing?" asked Justice Amy Coney Barrett. "If you have the evidence ... give her a chance to defend herself. That just wouldn't be that big of a deal."

Trump has sought to take control of the independent bank board because it has not lowered interest rates as far and [See Fed, A7]

Trump backs off military threat to Greenland

He says the U.S. has made a 'framework' deal with NATO chief over territory's future.

By MICHAEL WILNER AND ANA CEBALLOS

NUUK, Greenland — President Trump retreated Wednesday from his most serious threats toward Denmark, easing transatlantic tensions and lifting Wall Street after rejecting the prospect he would use military force to annex Greenland, a Danish territory and the world's largest island.

Instead, the United States struck a "framework" agreement in talks with the North Atlantic Treaty Organization's secretary-general regarding the future of Greenland, Trump wrote on social media. He provided few details but told reporters that the plan, if agreed upon and implemented, would be "the ultimate long-term deal."

The whiplash of developments followed weeks of escalating threats from the president to control Greenland by any means necessary — including by force, if left with no other choice.

Now, "the military's not on the table," Trump told reporters at the economic forum in Switzerland, acknowledging sighs of relief throughout the room.

"I don't think it will be necessary," he said. "I really don't. I think people are going to use better judgment."

It was a turn of events that came as welcome news in Nuuk, where signs hang in

storefronts and kitchen windows rejecting American imperialism.

"It's difficult to say what are negotiating tactics, and what the foundation is for him saying all of this," said Finn Meinel, an attorney born and raised in the Greenlandic capital. "It could be that joint pressure from the EU and NATO countries has made an impact, as well as the economic numbers in the States. Maybe that has had an influence."

In his speech at Davos, Trump took note of the market turmoil his threats against Greenland had caused entering the conference. Announcing the agreement framework on social media Wednesday, he said he would pause punitive tariffs planned against long-standing European allies that had refused to support his demands.

Prominent world leaders — including from Canada, France and the United Kingdom, among Washington's closest allies — had warned earlier this week that Trump's militant threats against a fellow NATO member were ushering in a new era of global order accommodating a less reliable United States.

For years, Trump has called for U.S. ownership over Greenland due to its strategic position in the Arctic Circle, where ice melting due to climate change is making way for a new era of competition with Russia and China. An Arctic conflict, the president says, will require a robust U.S. presence there.

[See Greenland, A6]

Newsom blocked: Governor says the White House prevented him from speaking at Davos. **WORLD, A6**
Key quotes: President Trump sharply criticizes NATO and European leaders at the forum. **WORLD, A6**

U.S. drops its legal fight against DEI

Administration won't pursue appeal of the ruling that blocked school funding threat.

By JAWEED KALEEM

Nearly a year after the Education Department threatened to withhold billions of dollars in federal funding unless schools and colleges eliminated diversity, equity and inclusion programs, the Trump administration on Wednesday

gave up a legal fight against DEI.

In a federal court filing, the U.S. government said it would drop its appeal of a federal court ruling that blocked its campaign against DEI in K-12 schools and higher education institutions — which it alleged discriminated against white students and employees — leaving in place a lower court finding that the effort violated the 1st Amendment and federal procedural rules.

Yet the nearly yearlong federal campaign and fund-

ing threats against DEI have prompted widespread overhauls and the elimination of diversity programs throughout the nation's education systems that education experts said will be difficult to reverse.

For at least dozens of college campuses across the nation, websites have been purged of mentions of DEI or diversity, DEI-related positions have been eliminated or changed, or students have lost access to culturally themed dorms focused on Black, Latino and LGBTQ+ students.

"The damage is done," said Shaun Harper, a professor of education, public policy and business at USC who is working on a documentary about DEI at universities.

The dispute centered on federal guidance issued nearly a year ago last February that told schools they would lose federal money for using "race in decisions pertaining to admissions, hiring, promotion, compensation, financial aid, scholarships, prizes, administrative support, discipline, housing, graduation cere-

[See DEI, A7]

Why did coyote swim across the Bay?

It's no joke. Video catches the first documented case of a landing on Alcatraz.

By ALEX WIGGLESWORTH

When Aidan Moore heard a guest had spotted a coyote on Alcatraz Island, he figured they were mistaken.

Then the visitor showed video proof to the 43-year-old, who drives a tram and helps people board tour boats on the island off San Francisco.

The video, taken Jan. 11, shows the coyote paddling to the southern shore and then climbing up onto some rocks, hunched and shivering. It does not show where



GARY CORONADO Los Angeles Times

"THE SWIM to Alcatraz is difficult even for a person in peak physical shape," a federal park official says.

the coyote came from or reveal its fate — whether it was washed back into the frigid water or trotted off into the island's interior.

The video, originally reported by SFGate, is the first documented instance of a coyote swimming to Alcatraz, scientists say. It came months after a coyote was shown on video swimming in the San Francisco Bay a couple of miles to the north, near Angel Island, where a lone coyote first traveled in 2017 before possibly being joined by another, resulting in a pack that now numbers at least 14.

In a storyline that may be recognizable to some human inhabitants, the coyotes probably are leaving the mainland in search of new [See Coyote, A7]

Iran warns U.S. amid moves by Pentagon

By JON GAMBRELL

DUBAI — Iran's foreign minister issued the most direct threat yet Wednesday against the United States after Tehran's bloody crackdown on protesters, warning the Islamic Republic will be "firing back with everything we have if we come under renewed attack."

The comments by Abbas Araghchi, who saw his invitation to the World Economic Forum in Davos, Switzerland, rescinded over the killings, comes as a U.S. aircraft carrier group moves west toward the Middle East from Asia. U.S. fighter jets and other equipment appear to be moving into the Mideast after a major U.S. military deployment in the Caribbean saw troops seize Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro.

Meanwhile, an Iranian Kurdish separatist group in Iraq claimed Iran targeted one of its bases in a drone and missile attack that killed at least one fighter.

Iran did not immediately acknowledge the attack, which would be the first foreign operation Tehran has launched since the protests started in late December.

Araghchi made the threat in an opinion article published by the Wall Street Journal. In it, the foreign minister contended "the violent phase of the unrest lasted less than 72 hours" and sought again to blame armed demonstrators for the violence. Videos that made it out of Iran despite [See Iran, A3]

Federal agent shoots at suspect

Officials say immigration officer fired at man after he rammed law enforcement with his vehicle. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

FCC takes aim at talk shows

Agency appears to target daytime and late night over "equal time" rule during politician interviews. **BUSINESS, A9**

Stafford rides out bumps, bruises

Rams quarterback has struggled since a finger injury, but he expects to deliver on Sunday in Seattle. **SPORTS, B10**

Weather
A couple of showers.
L.A. Basin: 66/51. **B6**

